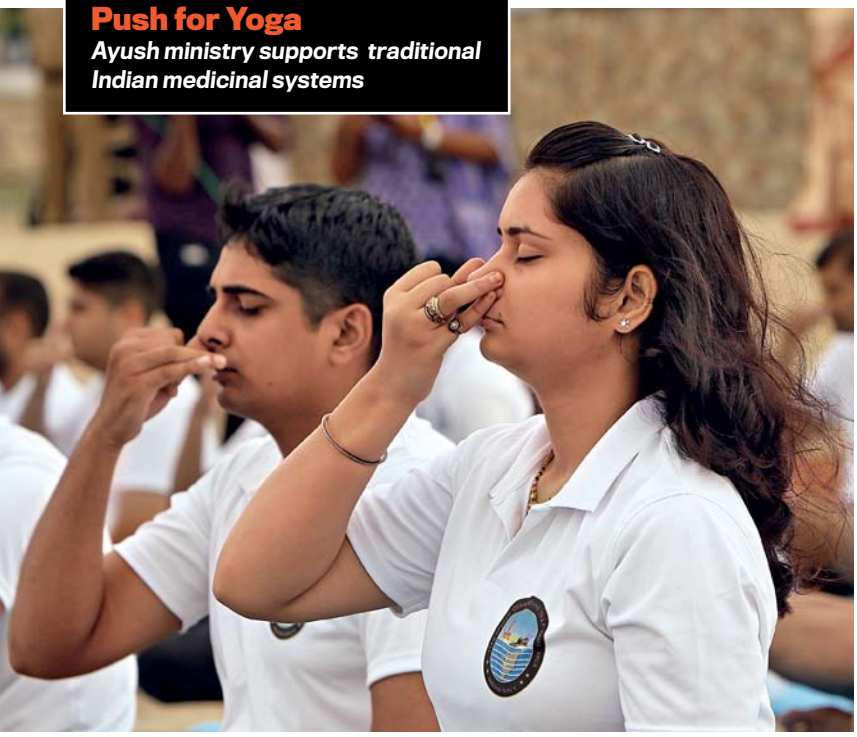
Push for Yoga
Ayush ministry supports traditional Indian medicinal systems



JAISON G

AYUSH

CHARM OFFENSIVE

Flush with funds, the Ayush ministry is brimming with ambitious plans to go global, and encourage entrepreneurship and mass production

By Kaushik Deka

WHAT'S DONE

- Ayush facilities co-located with 497 district hospitals, 2,757 community health centres and 7,779 primary health centres
- No. of patients treated with Ayush medicine in government hospitals went up up from 25 million in 2017-18 to 43 million in 2020-21
- National Accreditation Board for Hospitals & Healthcare Providers (NABH) accreditation given to 8 out of 12 national institutes of Ayush education associated hospitals
- Yoga Certification Board has given

CHALLENGES AHEAD

- Earning recognition for Ayush medicines in the US, EU and Ayush professional courses for medical practices in various countries
- Develop Ayurveda and Ayush-based products and services standards internationally

THE MINISTRY of Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha and Homeopathy (Ayush) was formed on November 9, 2014, with the vision to revive ancient Indian knowledge systems in medicine and healthcare and promote them among masses. During the pandemic, the ministry took several initiatives to popularise ancient Indian learnings as preventive healthcare methods for a healthy lifestyle. The government's focus on the ministry is evident—budgetary allocation for it nearly tripled from Rs 685.21 crore in 2014 to Rs 1,939.76 crore in 2019. This year, allocation was increased to Rs 3,050 crore. The major success of the ministry has been integration of AYUSH Health & Wellness Centre (AHWC) with the government's flagship health insurance scheme Ayushman Bharat. This will those following alternative medicinal treatment to get insurance benefits. Between 2017-18 and 2020-21, the number of patients visiting government-run Ayush centres grew by more than 70 per cent. In terms of education, the institute of Teaching and Research in Ayurveda (ITRA) at Jamnagar has been conferred the status of Institute of National Importance. National Institute of Ayurveda, Jaipur has been declared as an Institution Deemed to be University. ■